

Kevin Rufino

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EXPERIENCE

Product / Design Engineer

- CandidAugust 2025 - Present, New York, NY
- Defined an AI-native design system to code workflow — Figma Code Connect — boosting LLM legibility and dev velocity by ~85%.
 - Shipped an agentic B2B chat experience with a custom MCP server enabling natural-language tool use — owned SSE, Zustand state, and Generative UI.
 - Partnered cross functionally to deliver agentic experiences to data heavy dashboard UI's delivering integral data to the public sector.
 - Audited repo architecture for agent-readiness — implementing context maps, conventions, and docs turning AI coding tools into reliable contributors.

Front-End Web Engineer II

- NikeMay 2024 - August 2025, New York, NY
- Created \$2M+ in pre-order sales for the first time in the company's history by leading creative marketing page experience.
 - Architected and developed a scalable partnered marketing experience using SSR to improve page SEO, resulting in a 25% increase in satisfaction.
 - Created optimization pipeline for 3D assets, guiding engineers and designers on asset size recommendations and compression techniques.
 - Developed multiple a11y-compliant design system UI components utilizing Storybook to streamline the dev process, reducing TTM for new features.
 - Enhanced user interface stability by increasing test coverage of UI components using Jest, React Testing Library, and Cypress.
 - Mentored 2 interns in best practices, fostering a collaborative learning environment that resulted in the successful completion of assigned projects.

Front-End Web Engineer I

- NikeSeptember 2022 - May 2024, New York, NY
- Built 3D creative marketing components utilizing React, CSS animations, ThreeJS, R3F, GLSL shaders, and Canvas components.
 - Engineered a CMS using GraphQL and Contentful, reducing assets and copy update times by an estimated 4 hours per website update.
 - Constructed a workflow for fast R&D of creative development projects for quick response to design feedback.
 - Introduced analytics framework tracking consumer behavior across the platform, allowing for close and accurate consumer insights.
 - Assisted consumer research and insights in marketing and design briefs by working cross-functionally functionally.

Full Stack Application Security Software Engineer

- NikeSeptember 2021 - September 2022, Beaverton, OR
- Engineered a UI intake form for developers to submit their code for a Dynamic Application Security Testing (DAST) service.
 - Created an AWS CloudWatch dashboard tracking downtime and errors across multiple services on our platform.
 - Implemented CI/CD for infrastructure as code on the team's AWS CDK stacks.
 - Developed front-end using ReactJS, connecting to the backend Mongo DB and third-party security testing services such as Acunetix.

PROJECTS

moodi - Mood Board Recommendation Algorithm

- Designed momentum-based snap pan with spring-eased focus transitions, keeping the grid aligned post-gesture and honoring reduced-motion.
- Sole author of a taste-based recommendation engine (Next.js, TypeScript, Vercel) turning an image archive into a navigable similarity space.
- Built a GPU-batched CLIP embedding worker (Python/FastAPI, ViT-L/14, 768-dim), [N]× faster than CPU inference at zero API cost.
- Four-table Supabase/Postgres schema; pgvector HNSW cut neighbor lookups from [N]ms to [N]ms p95, with UMAP layouts precomputed offline.
- Canvas UI sustaining a [N]ms frame budget under pan-zoom via viewport culling and a texture cache capped at [N]MB.

Online Minecraft for Web

- Engineered a fully playable, scalable 3D voxel game in the browser, simulating Minecraft using R3F, WebGL, and Socket.IO for real-time multiplayer.
- Designed a procedural terrain generation algorithm that constructs a randomized, interactive voxel world on demand.
- Built a custom physics engine integration using Cannon.JS for realistic player-world interactions.
- Architected a real-time server-client communication layer with web sockets to sync player actions and world updates.
- Optimized 3D rendering performance and memory usage to support stable frame rates across complex environments.
- Drove the project end-to-end to explore large-scale front-end architecture, real-time systems, and GPU-bound rendering in browsers.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Grand Valley State University • Allendale, MI • 2021

INVOLVEMENT

Chapter Founder and President

- Allendale, MI • Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers (SHPE) • December 2019 - May 2021
- Visited local predominantly Black and Hispanic lower income schools to inform children on STEM paths and provide mentorship.
 - Set up resume and networking workshops with Hispanic professionals in our community.
 - Founded local chapter recruiter requiring me to recruit 10 members to be officially recognized by the organization and my school.

SKILLS

Frontend: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, HTML, CSS, Zustand, Framer Motion, SSR | **Design Systems:** Figma, Figma Code Connect, Storybook, design tokens, WCAG / a11y | **AI / Agentic:** MCP, Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, LLM integration, function calling / tool use, prompt + context engineering | **Real-time / Backend:** Node.js, GraphQL, SSE, WebSockets, Resend, React Email, SQL, Python | **3D / Creative:** Three.js, R3F, Drei, WebGL, GLSL, Blender, Photoshop | **Testing:** Jest, React Testing Library, Cypress